

Marketing Dialogue Lab

Realistic marketing-workplace dialogues, role-play cards, and debrief prompts for advanced ESL learners

Audience: instructors, marketing English coaches, marketing teams, agency teams, and peer practice cohorts

Focus: high-level professional English for marketing workplaces, including customer insight, positioning, campaign briefs, content, SEO, paid media, lifecycle marketing, analytics, attribution, compliance, brand risk, and realistic marketing dialogue.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already work in marketing, product marketing, growth, content, brand, marketing operations, demand generation, social, agency, or marketing-adjacent roles.

Teaching stance: marketing English is persuasion under constraint. Learners need to be clear, creative, evidence-aware, compliance-aware, and commercially useful. This course teaches professional language and judgment, not a guarantee that a campaign, channel, claim, or tactic will work in every market.

How to Run the Dialogue Lab

1. Use groups of three: marketing speaker, stakeholder, observer.
2. Read the model dialogue once. Then replay it with a different audience, channel, metric, risk, or stakeholder pressure.
3. The observer listens for audience clarity, strategic questions, evidence, metric caveats, compliance awareness, and decision language.
4. After each role-play, replay the hardest 30 seconds with a more precise marketing sentence.

Facilitator guardrail

Do not let learners hide behind buzzwords. Ask them to define the audience, decision, metric source, proof, channel rationale, and compliance or brand risk.

1. Campaign Brief: 'We Need Awareness'

Setting

A VP asks for a campaign but cannot define the target audience or business outcome.

Speaker	Line
VP	We need a big awareness campaign next month.
Marketing lead	Awareness among whom, and what should they do after seeing it?
ESL learner	Before we brief creative, we need to define the audience, insight, message, channel, budget, and measurement. Awareness for executives is different from awareness for end users.
VP	Just make noise in the market.
ESL learner	We can create visibility, but to spend responsibly we need a specific audience and a signal of success, such as branded search lift, site visits from target accounts, or sales conversations.

Language notes

- Good marketers turn vague requests into strategic questions.
- Awareness should still have audience, channel, and measurement discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

We can create visibility, but to spend responsibly we need a specific audience and a signal of success, such as branded search lift, site visits from target accounts, or sales _____.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	conversations
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A VP asks for a campaign but cannot define the target audience or business outcome.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	We can create visibility, but to spend responsibly we need a specific audience and a signal of success, such as branded search lift, site visits from target accounts, or sales conversations.
C	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A VP asks for a campaign but cannot define the target audience or business outcome.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	Verify conversations, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

2. Positioning Debate: Product Feature vs Customer Problem

Setting

Product wants the homepage headline to lead with a technical feature.

Speaker	Line
Product manager	The headline should say 'AI-powered orchestration layer.' That is the feature.
Content lead	Customers may not know why that matters.
ESL learner	Can we lead with the customer problem and use the feature as proof? The buyer cares about reducing manual handoffs and missed approvals. 'AI-powered orchestration' supports the claim, but it should not be the whole message.
Product manager	But competitors say similar things.
ESL learner	Then the proof matters even more: workflow examples, time saved, integration depth, and customer evidence.

Language notes

- Positioning should connect product capability to customer value.
- A feature can be a proof point, not necessarily the main message.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Then the proof matters even more: workflow examples, time saved, integration depth, and customer _____.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	evidence
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (Product wants the homepage headline to lead with a technical feature.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
B	evidence threshold
C	Then the proof matters even more: workflow examples, time saved, integration depth, and customer evidence.
D	Let's avoid naming evidence until the discussion is over.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (Product wants the homepage headline to lead with a technical feature.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	Verify evidence, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	approval path

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

3. Paid Search: ROAS Looks Good, Sales Quality Is Weak

Setting

Marketing reports strong ad-platform ROAS, but sales says leads are poor.

Speaker	Line
Performance marketer	Google Ads shows a 5.2 ROAS. We should scale budget.
Sales director	The leads are not converting to qualified opportunities.
ESL learner	Platform ROAS is useful, but we need to reconcile it with CRM revenue, lead quality, and sales-cycle stage. Are these conversions high-intent demo requests or low-intent content downloads?
Performance marketer	Mostly webinar registrations.
ESL learner	Then I would not scale yet. Let's separate acquisition cost by conversion type and optimize toward qualified pipeline, not only form fills.

Language notes

- ROAS can be misleading if conversion quality is weak.
- Marketing and sales need shared definitions for conversion and quality.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Then I would not scale yet. Let's separate acquisition cost by conversion type and optimize toward qualified _____, not only form fills.

Option	Phrase
A	pipeline
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (Marketing reports strong ad-platform ROAS, but sales says leads are poor.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	I can approve the result now and look at pipeline after the decision.
B	Let's avoid naming pipeline until the discussion is over.
C	Then I would not scale yet. Let's separate acquisition cost by conversion type and optimize toward qualified pipeline, not only form fills.
D	decision owner

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (Marketing reports strong ad-platform ROAS, but sales says leads are poor.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.
C	Verify pipeline, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	operating constraint

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

4. Attribution Fight: Last Click vs Influenced Pipeline

Setting

The CFO questions whether marketing really created pipeline.

Speaker	Line
CFO	Sales says they sourced this opportunity. Marketing says it influenced it. Which is true?
Marketing ops	Both can be true under different attribution models.
ESL learner	Last-click attribution shows the final touch before conversion. Influenced pipeline shows that marketing touched the account during the buying journey. Neither model alone proves causality.
CFO	So what should I trust?
ESL learner	Trust the model for the question it can answer. For budget decisions, we should combine attribution, incrementality tests, sales feedback, and pipeline quality.

Language notes

- Attribution explains credit rules, not necessarily causal impact.
- Executive language should clarify what the model can and cannot prove.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Trust the model for the question it can answer. For budget decisions, we should combine attribution, incrementality tests, sales feedback, and pipeline _____.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	quality
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (The CFO questions whether marketing really created pipeline.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	Trust the model for the question it can answer. For budget decisions, we should combine attribution, incrementality tests, sales feedback, and pipeline quality.
B	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (The CFO questions whether marketing really created pipeline.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Verify quality, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

5. Creative Review: Taste vs Brief

Setting

A senior stakeholder dislikes a social ad concept because it does not match their personal taste.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	I do not like this. It feels too informal.
Designer	The brief asked for approachable and direct.
ESL learner	Can we evaluate it against the brief? The target audience is first-time managers, the objective is webinar registration, and the tone is meant to reduce intimidation. The question is whether this creative makes the next step feel accessible.
Stakeholder	But our brand is premium.
ESL learner	Agreed. We can preserve premium through layout and proof, while keeping the language human enough for the audience.

Language notes

- Creative feedback should reference audience, brief, objective, and brand system.
- Taste language is weaker than criteria-based feedback.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Agreed. We can preserve premium through layout and proof, while keeping the language human enough for the

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	audience
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A senior stakeholder dislikes a social ad concept because it does not match their personal taste.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
B	Agreed. We can preserve premium through layout and proof, while keeping the language human enough for the audience.
C	I can approve the result now and look at audience after the decision.
D	Let's avoid naming audience until the discussion is over.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A senior stakeholder dislikes a social ad concept because it does not match their personal taste.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.
B	Verify audience, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
C	decision owner
D	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

6. MQL Definition: Marketing and Sales Disagree

Setting

Sales rejects many leads that marketing counts as MQLs.

Speaker	Line
Sales manager	These MQLs are not ready. They downloaded one guide and never replied.
Demand gen	They meet the scoring threshold.
ESL learner	Then the score may be overweighting engagement and underweighting fit or buying intent. We should define MQL as fit plus behavior, and create a recycle path for leads that are interested but not sales-ready.
Sales manager	What changes?
ESL learner	Add firmographic fit, require stronger intent for handoff, and create feedback reasons when sales rejects a lead.

Language notes

- Lifecycle definitions need shared ownership.
- A rejected lead should produce feedback, not only blame.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Add firmographic fit, require stronger intent for handoff, and create feedback reasons when sales _____ a lead.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	rejects
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (Sales rejects many leads that marketing counts as MQLs.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	Let's avoid naming rejects until the discussion is over.
B	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
C	Add firmographic fit, require stronger intent for handoff, and create feedback reasons when sales rejects a lead.
D	I can approve the result now and look at rejects after the decision.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (Sales rejects many leads that marketing counts as MQLs.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	Verify rejects, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	evidence threshold

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

7. SEO and Legal Review: Claim Too Strong

Setting

A content article uses a bold claim that legal says is unsupported.

Speaker	Line
SEO manager	This headline will rank and convert.
Legal	The claim 'cuts costs in half' needs substantiation.
ESL learner	Can we keep the search intent but adjust the claim? For example, 'ways to reduce support costs' is safer than promising a specific result unless we have evidence that result is typical.
SEO manager	Will that weaken the headline?
ESL learner	Maybe, but an unsupported claim creates regulatory and trust risk. We can strengthen the article with a case study, methodology, and clearer qualifiers.

Language notes

- SEO pressure does not remove claim-substantiation requirements.
- Good revision protects usefulness and compliance.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Maybe, but an unsupported claim creates regulatory and trust _____. We can strengthen the article with a case study, methodology, and clearer qualifiers.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	risk
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A content article uses a bold claim that legal says is unsupported.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	Maybe, but an unsupported claim creates regulatory and trust risk. We can strengthen the article with a case study, methodology, and clearer qualifiers.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A content article uses a bold claim that legal says is unsupported.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.
B	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.
C	evidence threshold
D	Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

8. Email Readout: Open Rate Is Up, Revenue Is Flat

Setting

Lifecycle marketing reviews an email campaign with a high open rate but low revenue impact.

Speaker	Line
Lifecycle marketer	Open rate increased by 12 percent after the new subject line.
VP Marketing	Did it produce more revenue?
ESL learner	Open rate is a weak success metric by itself, especially with privacy-related measurement noise. Click rate, conversion, unsubscribe rate, and downstream revenue tell us more about intent.
Lifecycle marketer	So was the test a failure?
ESL learner	Not necessarily. The subject line improved attention, but the offer or landing page may not have moved people to action.

Language notes

- Email metrics require caveats.
- Open rate can be useful, but it should not be the only decision metric.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Not necessarily. The subject line improved attention, but the offer or landing page may not have moved people to _____.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	action
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (Lifecycle marketing reviews an email campaign with a high open rate but low revenue impact.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	Not necessarily. The subject line improved attention, but the offer or landing page may not have moved people to action.
B	Let's avoid naming action until the discussion is over.
C	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (Lifecycle marketing reviews an email campaign with a high open rate but low revenue impact.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.
B	evidence threshold
C	Verify action, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

9. Influencer Campaign: Disclosure and Authenticity

Setting

A brand manager wants an influencer to make the post feel organic.

Speaker	Line
Brand manager	Can the creator avoid saying it is sponsored? It performs better if it feels natural.
Social lead	That creates disclosure risk.
ESL learner	If there is payment, free product, or another material connection, the audience needs a clear disclosure. We can still make the content authentic, but not hidden.
Brand manager	Will that hurt engagement?
ESL learner	Possibly, but undisclosed sponsorship creates legal and trust risk. Let's optimize the creative, not hide the relationship.

Language notes

- Influencer language should separate authenticity from undisclosed advertising.
- Material connection disclosure is a key compliance concept.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Possibly, but undisclosed sponsorship creates legal and trust _____. Let's optimize the creative, not hide the relationship.

Option	Phrase
A	risk
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A brand manager wants an influencer to make the post feel organic.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	Possibly, but undisclosed sponsorship creates legal and trust risk. Let's optimize the creative, not hide the relationship.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A brand manager wants an influencer to make the post feel organic.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.
B	Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
C	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.
D	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

10. Agency Budget: More Spend or Better Brief?

Setting

An agency asks for more paid budget after campaign performance stalls.

Speaker	Line
Agency	We are seeing diminishing returns. Additional budget will help us find new audiences.
Client	Why should we spend more if performance is worse?
ESL learner	Before increasing spend, let's diagnose the constraint: audience saturation, creative fatigue, landing page conversion, offer relevance, or targeting. More budget may amplify the same problem.
Agency	We can test new creative.
ESL learner	Good. Please bring a test plan with hypothesis, audience, budget, decision rule, and what we will pause if the test underperforms.

Language notes

- Budget requests need diagnosis and decision criteria.
- A test plan should include what will change after the result.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Good. Please bring a test plan with hypothesis, audience, budget, decision rule, and what we will pause if the test

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	underperforms
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (An agency asks for more paid budget after campaign performance stalls.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	Good. Please bring a test plan with hypothesis, audience, budget, decision rule, and what we will pause if the test underperforms.
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (An agency asks for more paid budget after campaign performance stalls.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	Verify underperforms, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	evidence threshold

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

11. A/B Test: Inconclusive Result

Setting

A landing-page test shows a small lift but insufficient sample size.

Speaker	Line
Growth marketer	Variant B is up 6 percent. Let's ship it.
Analyst	The sample is too small to call a winner.
ESL learner	The direction is promising, but the result is inconclusive. We can extend the test, combine it with qualitative review, or ship only if the implementation cost is low and downside risk is minimal.
Growth marketer	I need a decision today.
ESL learner	Then frame it as a business decision under uncertainty, not a proven test result.

Language notes

- A test readout should protect the difference between signal and proof.
- Sometimes the decision is practical, but the evidence label must stay honest.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Then frame it as a business decision under uncertainty, not a proven test result _____.

Option	Phrase
A	result
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A landing-page test shows a small lift but insufficient sample size.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	Then frame it as a business decision under uncertainty, not a proven test result.
B	I can approve the result now and look at result after the decision.
C	Let's avoid naming result until the discussion is over.
D	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A landing-page test shows a small lift but insufficient sample size.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.
B	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.
C	Verify result, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

12. Social Backlash: Holding Statement

Setting

A campaign receives criticism for appearing insensitive.

Speaker	Line
Community manager	Negative comments are accelerating. Do we delete them?
Comms lead	Not unless they violate policy. We need a response path.
ESL learner	First, pause scheduled promotion, capture examples, confirm facts, and align with legal and customer support. The public holding statement should acknowledge concern without speculating or blaming.
VP	What can we say now?
ESL learner	We are listening to the feedback, reviewing the campaign, and will share an update when we have confirmed next steps. Internally, we need an owner for response timing and approval.

Language notes

- Crisis language should be calm, factual, and coordinated.
- Do not delete or respond impulsively without policy and escalation guidance.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

We are listening to the feedback, reviewing the campaign, and will share an update when we have confirmed next steps. Internally, we need an _____ for response timing and approval.

Option	Phrase
A	owner
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A campaign receives criticism for appearing insensitive.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	Let's avoid naming owner until the discussion is over.
B	We are listening to the feedback, reviewing the campaign, and will share an update when we have confirmed next steps. Internally, we need an owner for response timing and approval.
C	decision owner
D	I can approve the result now and look at owner after the decision.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A campaign receives criticism for appearing insensitive.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.
B	Verify owner, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Observer checklist

- Did the learner clarify audience, goal, and decision before discussing tactics?
- Did the learner use marketing terms accurately and define metrics when needed?
- Did the learner connect creative, channel, or budget advice to evidence?
- Did the learner identify compliance, brand, data, or trust risk when relevant?

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

1. Campaign Brief: 'We Need Awareness' - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. conversations	'conversations' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

1. Campaign Brief: 'We Need Awareness' - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. We can create visibility, but to spend responsibly we need a specific audience and a signal of success, such as branded search lift, site visits from target accounts, or sales conversations.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

1. Campaign Brief: 'We Need Awareness' - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Verify conversations, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

2. Positioning Debate: Product Feature vs Customer Problem - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. evidence	'evidence' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

2. Positioning Debate: Product Feature vs Customer Problem - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Then the proof matters even more: workflow examples, time saved, integration depth, and customer evidence.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

2. Positioning Debate: Product Feature vs Customer Problem - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify evidence, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

3. Paid Search: ROAS Looks Good, Sales Quality Is Weak - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. pipeline	'pipeline' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

3. Paid Search: ROAS Looks Good, Sales Quality Is Weak - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Then I would not scale yet. Let's separate acquisition cost by conversion type and optimize toward qualified pipeline, not only form fills.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

3. Paid Search: ROAS Looks Good, Sales Quality Is Weak - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify pipeline, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

4. Attribution Fight: Last Click vs Influenced Pipeline - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. quality	'quality' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

4. Attribution Fight: Last Click vs Influenced Pipeline - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Trust the model for the question it can answer. For budget decisions, we should combine attribution, incrementality tests, sales feedback, and pipeline quality.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

4. Attribution Fight: Last Click vs Influenced Pipeline - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify quality, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

5. Creative Review: Taste vs Brief - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. audience	'audience' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

5. Creative Review: Taste vs Brief - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Agreed. We can preserve premium through layout and proof, while keeping the language human enough for the audience.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

5. Creative Review: Taste vs Brief - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Verify audience, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

6. MQL Definition: Marketing and Sales Disagree - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. rejects	'rejects' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

6. MQL Definition: Marketing and Sales Disagree - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Add firmographic fit, require stronger intent for handoff, and create feedback reasons when sales rejects a lead.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

6. MQL Definition: Marketing and Sales Disagree - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify rejects, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

7. SEO and Legal Review: Claim Too Strong - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. risk	'risk' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

7. SEO and Legal Review: Claim Too Strong - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Maybe, but an unsupported claim creates regulatory and trust risk. We can strengthen the article with a case study, methodology, and clearer qualifiers.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

7. SEO and Legal Review: Claim Too Strong - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

8. Email Readout: Open Rate Is Up, Revenue Is Flat - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. action	'action' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

8. Email Readout: Open Rate Is Up, Revenue Is Flat - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Not necessarily. The subject line improved attention, but the offer or landing page may not have moved people to action.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

8. Email Readout: Open Rate Is Up, Revenue Is Flat - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify action, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

9. Influencer Campaign: Disclosure and Authenticity - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. risk	'risk' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

9. Influencer Campaign: Disclosure and Authenticity - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Possibly, but undisclosed sponsorship creates legal and trust risk. Let's optimize the creative, not hide the relationship.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

9. Influencer Campaign: Disclosure and Authenticity - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

10. Agency Budget: More Spend or Better Brief? - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. underperforms	'underperforms' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

10. Agency Budget: More Spend or Better Brief? - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Good. Please bring a test plan with hypothesis, audience, budget, decision rule, and what we will pause if the test underperforms.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

10. Agency Budget: More Spend or Better Brief? - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify underperforms, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

11. A/B Test: Inconclusive Result - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. result	'result' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

11. A/B Test: Inconclusive Result - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Then frame it as a business decision under uncertainty, not a proven test result.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

11. A/B Test: Inconclusive Result - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify result, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

12. Social Backlash: Holding Statement - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. owner	'owner' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

12. Social Backlash: Holding Statement - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. We are listening to the feedback, reviewing the campaign, and will share an update when we have confirmed next steps. Internally, we need an owner for response timing and approval.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

12. Social Backlash: Holding Statement - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Verify owner, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.